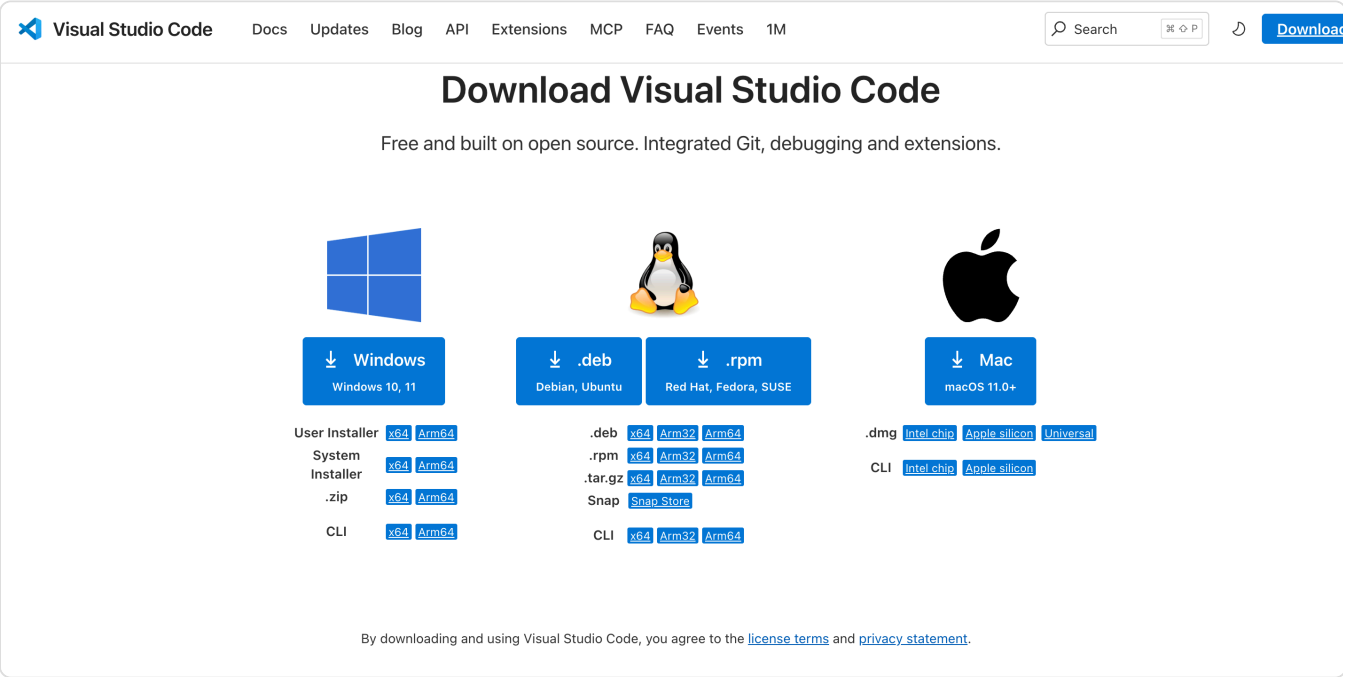
Workshop Setup Guide — VS Code + Claude Code

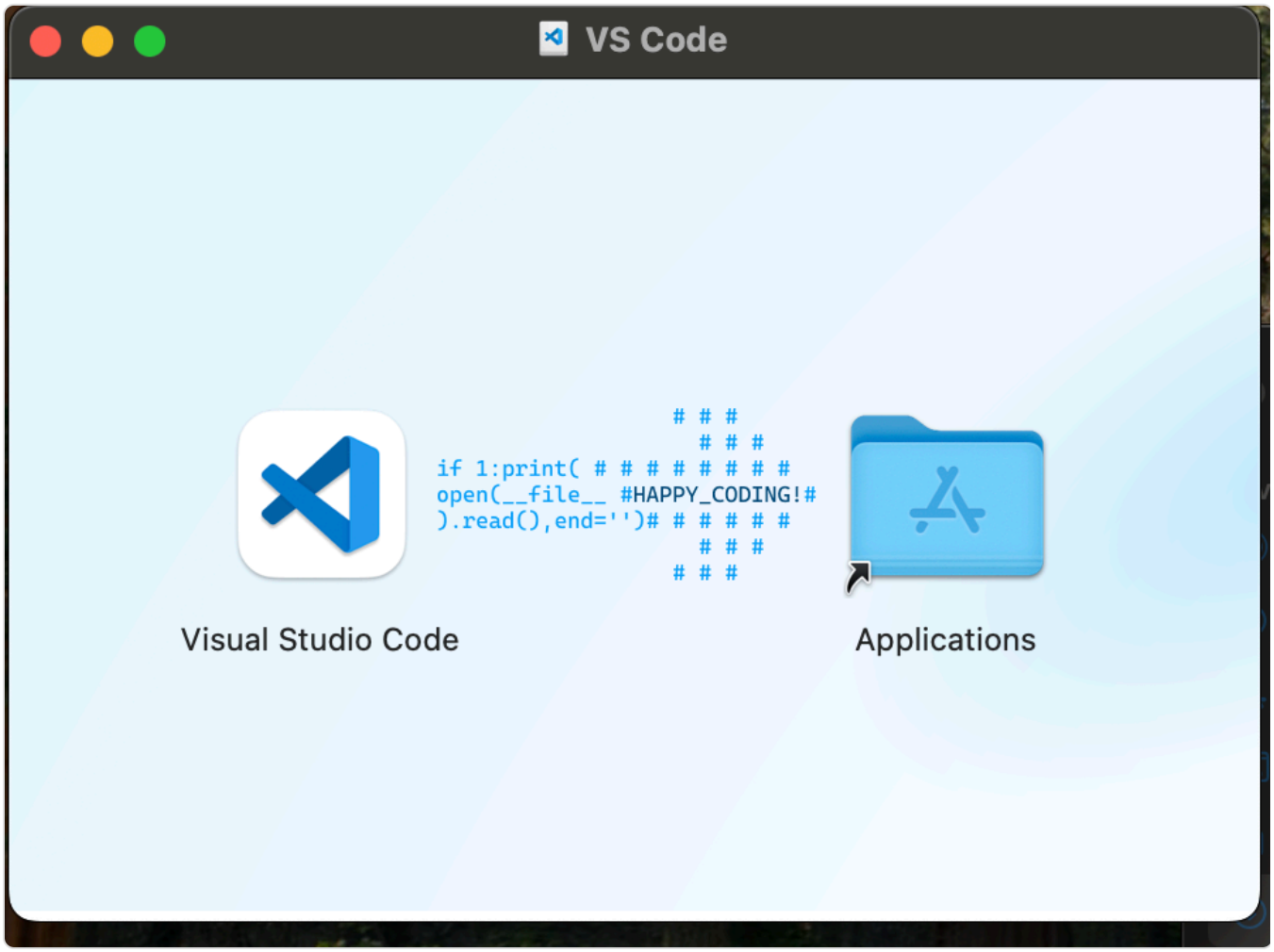
Prerequisite: A paid Claude account (Pro at $20/mo or Max at $100/mo). Sign up at **claude.ai/pricing** before the workshop.

Part 1: Install VS Code (Mac)

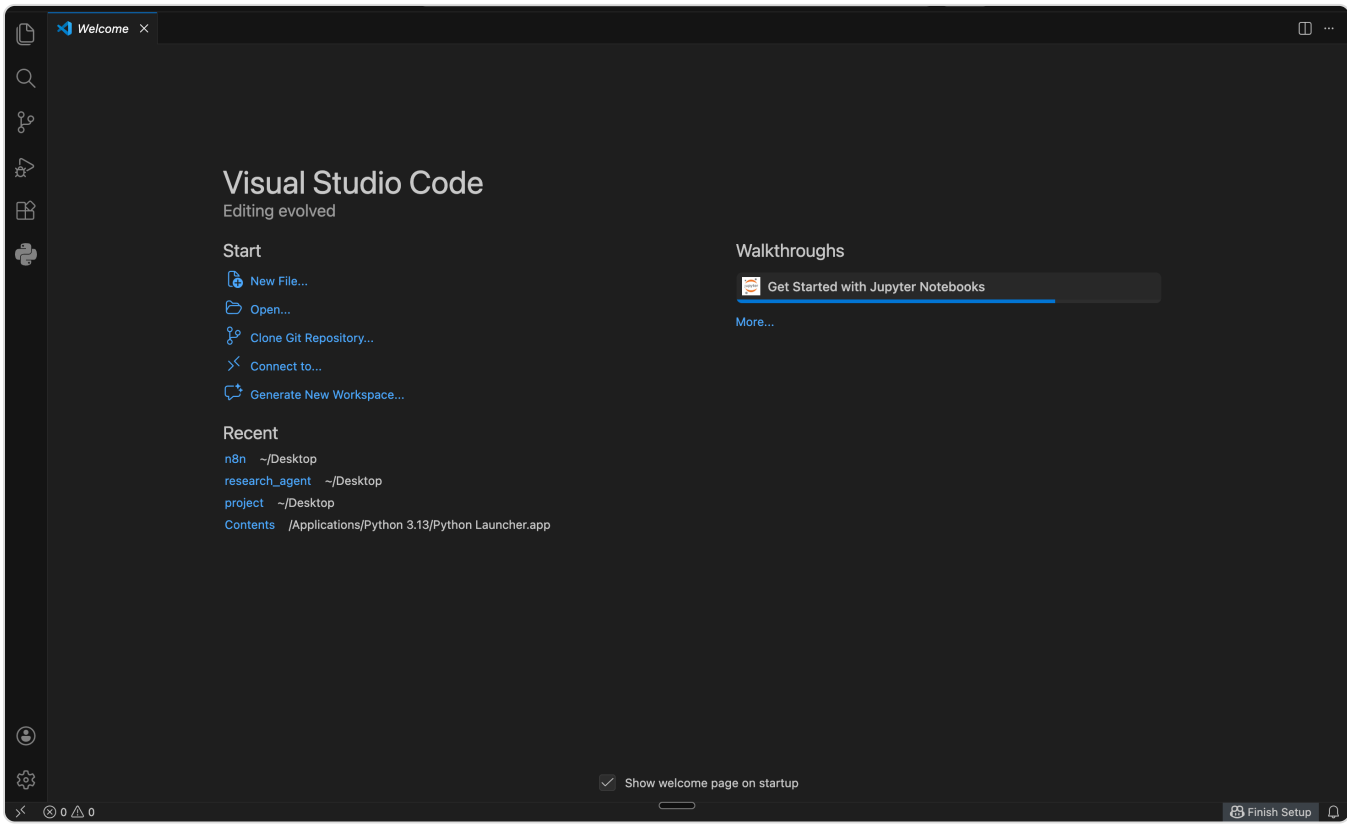
1. Go to **code.visualstudio.com/download** and click the **Mac** download button



1. Open the downloaded file. Drag **Visual Studio Code** into your **Applications** folder



1. Open VS Code from Applications. You should see the Welcome screen:



Part 1b: Install VS Code (Windows)

1. Go to **code.visualstudio.com/download** and click the **Windows** download button
2. Run the downloaded `.exe` installer
3. Click Next through all steps with default settings — when you see **"Add to PATH"**, make sure it's checked
4. Open VS Code from the Start Menu — you'll see the same Welcome screen

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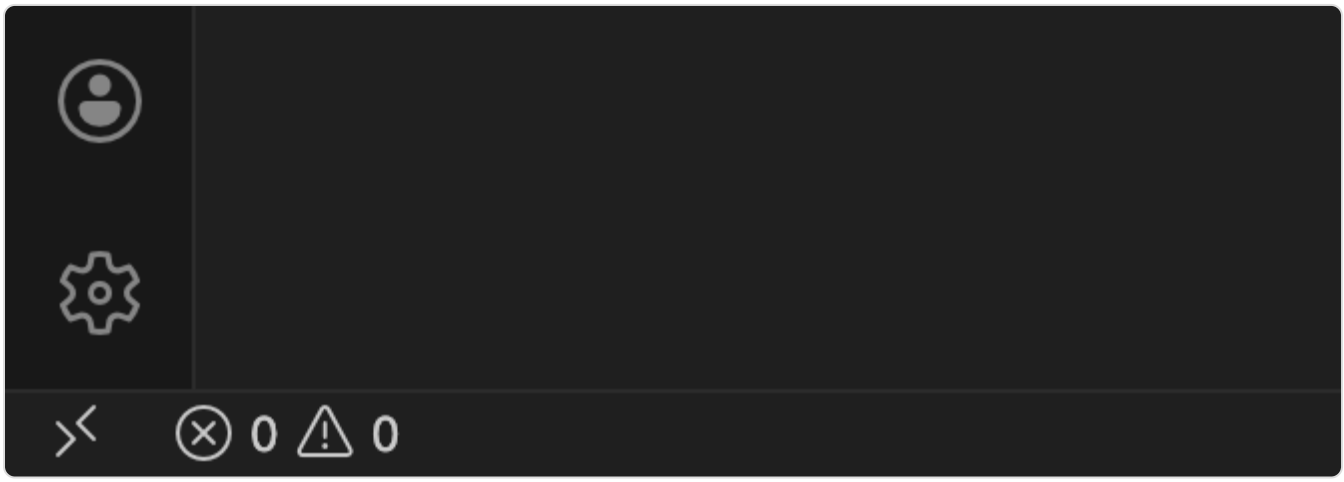
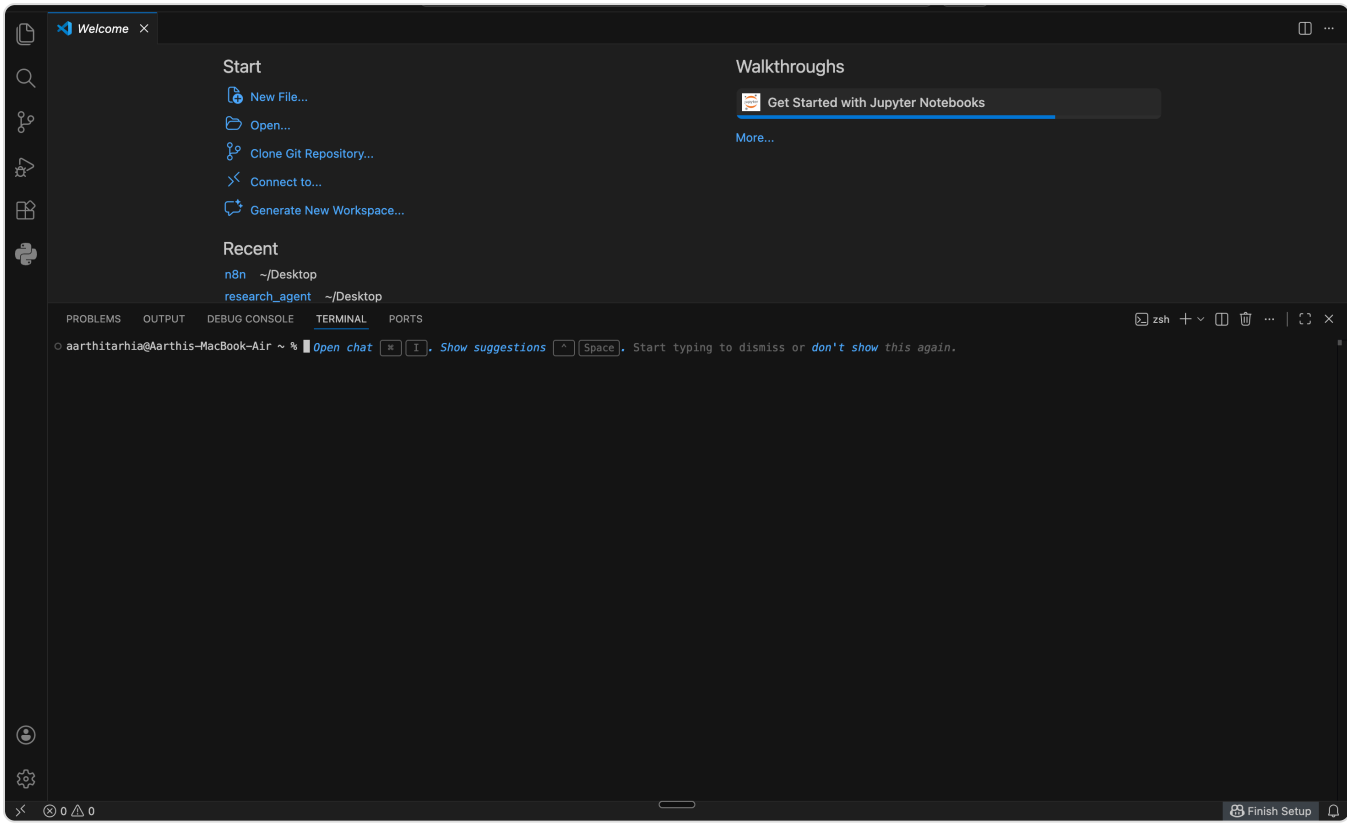
Part 2: Open the Terminal

1. Look at the **bottom-left corner** of VS Code. You'll see small icons in the status bar — click on the **error/warning area** (⊗ 0 ⚠ 0) to open the bottom panel



1. The bottom panel opens. Click the **TERMINAL** tab. You now have a command line inside VS Code:



> **Tip:** You can also open the terminal from the menu: **Terminal → New Terminal**

Part 3: Install Claude Code

In the VS Code terminal, paste and run:

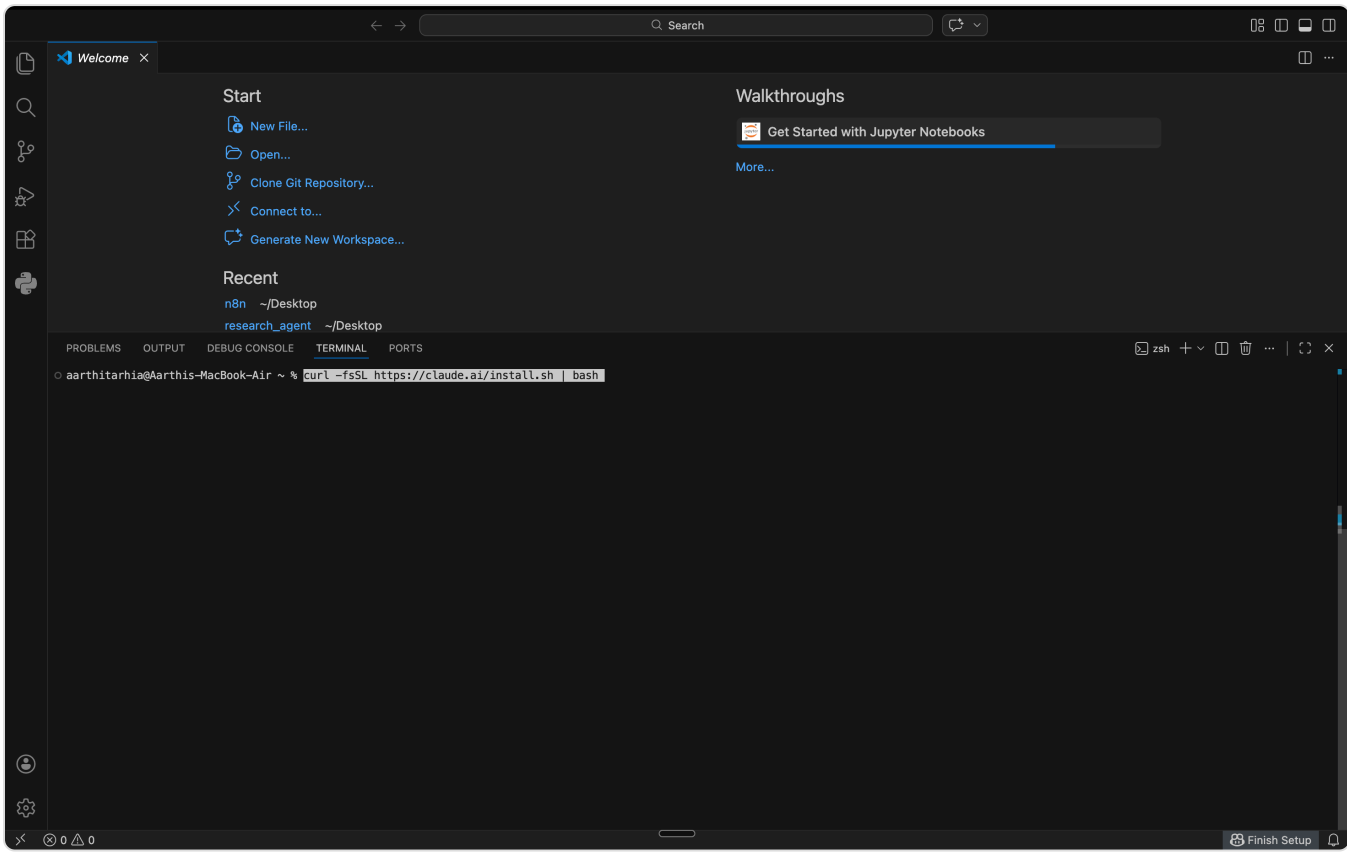
Mac:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

Windows (install **Git for Windows** from **git-scm.com/downloads/win** first):

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

This is what it looks like in the terminal:



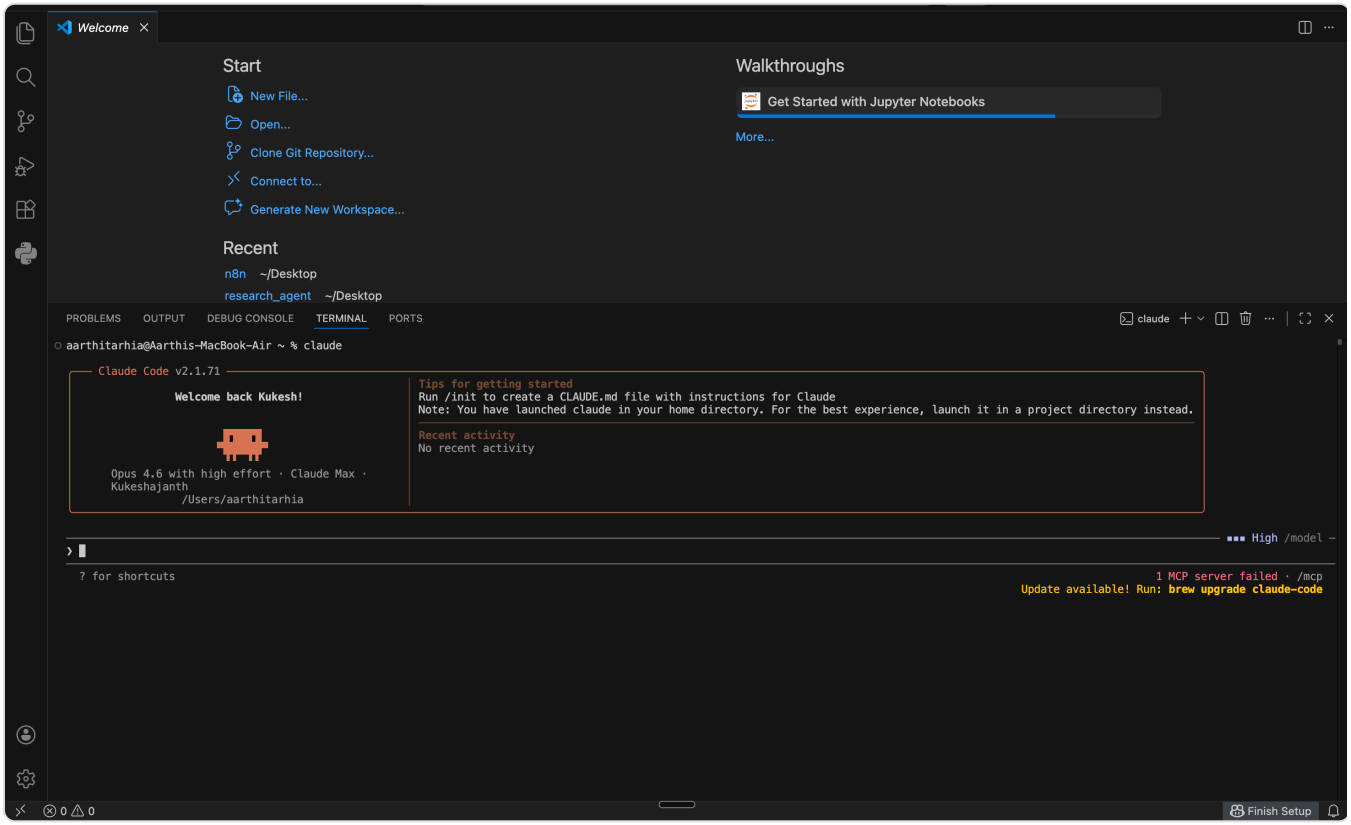
After it finishes, close the terminal (click the trash icon 🗑 in the terminal panel) and open a new one: **Terminal → New Terminal**

Part 4: Launch Claude Code

In the new terminal, run:

```
claude
```

Your browser opens — sign in with your Claude account, then come back to VS Code. You should see the Claude Code welcome screen:



You're all set. Claude Code remembers your login — you won't need to sign in again.

Quick Fixes

Problem	Fix
`command not found` after install	Close the terminal, open a new one: Terminal → New Terminal
Browser doesn't open for login	Press **c** to copy the login URL, paste in your browser
`irm is not recognized` (Windows)	Make sure the terminal says "powershell", not "cmd"
`claude` hangs on Windows	Install Git for Windows first, then retry